attribute is an integer value indicating the number of words that can be ignored in a phrase during a `match_phrase` search. For example, `slop` with a value of `1` ignores one word missing from a phrase, `slop` with a value of `2` forgives two words, and so on. The default value of `slop` is `0`, meaning we are not forgiven for providing a phrase with missing words.

Returning to our earlier example, let's drop the word *for* from the given phrase so that instead of "book for every Java programmer", we search for "book every Java programmer". Because we drop a single word, we need to set the `slop` parameter to `1`. We also need to expand the query by providing two additional parameters in the `query` and `slop` objects for the `synopsis` field.

Listing 10.11 A `match_phrase` query with `slop` that drops one word

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match_phrase": {
      "synopsis": {
        "query": "book every Java programmer",
        "slop": 1
      }
    }
  }
}
```

We expand this field to include an object with additional parameters.

Phrase with one missing word: for

Sets slop to 1, meaning the query looks for phrases with a single missing word

If we want to use the `slop` parameter, both `query` and `slop` must be provided along with the field's object, as shown in listing 10.11 (the long form of the query). Because `slop` is set to 1, the query matches if one word is missing in an entire phrase in the `synopsis` field. This query returns the book matching our entire phrase. The takeaway is that a `match_phrase` query looks for an exact phrase, but if we are unsure about our search, we can use the `slop` parameter to indicate how forgiving our query should be.

The `match_phrase` query has a slight variation: the `match_phrase_prefix` query. In addition to matching an exact phrase, we can match the last word as a prefix. Let's discuss this next with an example.

10.7 The match_phrase_prefix query

A `match_phrase_prefix` query is like a `match_phrase` query in that, in addition to matching the exact phrase, the query matches all the words, using the last word in the search phrase as a prefix. This is easier to understand via an example. The following listing searches for the prefix "found" in the tags, which can apply to "foundation", "founded", and so on.

Listing 10.12 Using a `match_phrase_prefix` query

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
```